

**Location**

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Nikola Lazarov

Senior Front-End Developer

Transitioning to C++/Rust, Linux & Systems Programming

Summary

Senior Front-End Developer with 6+ years of experience at Progress, where I've progressed from intern to senior developer since 2018.

I create YouTube educational content about software engineering what I'm learning. Explaining concepts to others is one of the best ways I learn.

I'm currently transitioning my career toward Linux and native systems programming with C++ and Rust. I'm interested in graphics programming and GUI applications development. Outside of work, I build projects to develop these skills, ranging from native Linux applications to Rust libraries, parsers, developer tooling, and consumer software.

Experience

Progress Software

Senior Front-End Developer

March 2020 - Present

Intern Front-End Developer

March 2018 - September 2018

Built and maintained component libraries and internal tools for the corporate websites, ensuring consistency, performance, and accessibility across a rapidly evolving marketing environment.

Led architectural modernization initiatives to improve stack maintainability and collaborated on key technical decisions that enhanced system scalability.

Established comprehensive documentation systems with Storybook and created onboarding resources that improve consistency and accessibility for new developers.

Developed accessibility and performance monitoring tool using open source technologies to maintain quality standards across large-scale websites updated by multiple teams while reducing external tooling costs.

Education

American University in Bulgaria

Bachelor of Arts

Computer Science & Information Systems

March 2016 - 2020

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Skills

Computer Science & Software Engineering: Strong foundation in computer science fundamentals, data structures, algorithms, and software engineering principles, with an emphasis on applying them in practical projects.

Programming Languages: C++, Rust, Swift, and JavaScript/TypeScript are my primary languages for current projects. I have experience with Java and C#, and actively explore newer languages like Zig and Odin.

Systems & Infrastructure: Daily user of Linux, Windows, and macOS, with a growing focus on Linux systems programming. I'm actively studying Unix and Linux interfaces and building projects to deepen my understanding of processes, system calls, networking, and low-level system APIs. I also have experience with Linux server administration, virtual machines, and container engines including Docker, Podman, and Apple Containers.

Database Systems: Experience with relational databases (PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQLite) and NoSQL solutions (MongoDB). Proficient in database design, optimization, and working with various data persistence patterns.

Web Technologies & APIs: Extensive experience with RESTful API design and HTTP protocol implementation. Deep knowledge of web accessibility compliance (WCAG standards), performance optimization techniques, and working with cutting-edge web technologies.

Selected Projects

CTL Dash

Native Linux service manager for the COSMIC desktop, written in Rust. Interfaces with systemd to inspect services, control their state, and view service details and logs.

Machina

Educational Linux system monitor written in C++23, exploring Linux APIs for system and process information. It is an immediate-mode graphical application built with Dear ImGui.

Budget Warden

Cross-platform budgeting application built around a shared Rust core and native clients for macOS, iOS, Android, and Windows. Uses generated FFI bindings to share domain logic across Swift, Kotlin, and C# applications.

Additional projects and experiments are available on my GitHub and personal website.